



🇸🇰 Day 01 · Aug 19 (Wed) · PRAGUE — full day + night

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



Traveler: Divyansh · solo · **PURE VEGETARIAN** (no meat, no fish, no seafood, eggs avoided)

Base: Prague Dream Hostel ☒ booked · check-in 3 PM · early bag-drop on arrival **Weather:** high ~25°C, low ~16°C · **60% chance of light passing showers** · sunset **20:13** → carry a compact umbrella + a light morning layer.

✈️ How you got here — Aug 18 (Tue) overnight flight

- **Mumbai (BOM) → Prague (PRG) via Doha (Qatar Airways)** ☒ booked — have your QR ready. Departs Mumbai evening (~21:40), **lands PRG ~7:00 AM Aug 19.**
- Veg meal (VGML/AVML) pre-ordered 24h+ ahead — reconfirm with cabin crew on boarding.
- **Sleep as much as possible on the plane** — you land at 7 AM and go straight into a full sightseeing day with no rest until 3 PM check-in. Beating jetlag in the air is the single biggest thing that saves today.
- Hydrate, skip alcohol, arrive fresh.

When to wake / when to leave

- **You don't set an alarm — the plane lands you at ~7:00 AM.** This is your Schengen first entry on the Czech-issued visa.
- Move fast through the airport so you can start Old Town by 9:00 AM.
- Have ready at passport control: visa + onward ticket (Aug 20 Barcelona) + return ticket (Sep 5). Confirm the visa sticker "valid until" is $\geq$ Sep 5.

Arrival sequence (7:00 – 8:50 AM)

Time	Step	Notes
07:00	Land PRG (Václav Havel)	—
07:00–07:30	Passport control (Schengen entry)	Visa + onward + return tickets in hand
07:30	Activate Airalo eSIM	Right after immigration so Bolt/Maps work
07:35	Bolt → Prague Dream Hostel	~450 CZK, ~30 min · cheaper + cleaner than airport taxi touts
08:10	Drop trolley at hostel	Check-in is 3 PM — use luggage storage (message the hostel in advance to confirm early bag-drop)
08:20	Breakfast: trdelník (chimney cake, veg) + coffee near Old Town	Cheap, iconic, quick

 **CASH FIRST:** Prague uses **Czech koruna (CZK)**, **NOT euro**. Withdraw from a **normal bank ATM in town** (ČSOB / KB / Česká spořitelna). **Avoid the airport exchange and any "Euronet" ATM** — terrible rates + fees. Card works most places, but carry CZK for towers, trams, small spots and the medieval tavern.

Hour-by-hour timeline

★ **Priority key:** ● must · ● optional · ● skip · 💎 hidden gem ● If jetlag hits, protect only these: Old Town Square/Clock → Old Town Hall Tower → Castle + St. Vitus → Charles Bridge **day AND night**. Everything else is droppable.

09:00 · ● **Old Town Square + Astronomical Clock — Free**

- Prague's medieval heart: pastel façades, the twin-spired **Týn Church**, and the **Astronomical Clock (Orloj, 1410)** — the world's oldest still-operating astronomical clock. On the hour the 12 Apostles parade past the windows.

- Heads-up: the hourly "show" is famously underwhelming — see it once, then go up the tower for the real payoff.

09:45 · 🚫 Old Town Hall Tower — ~350 CZK, walk-in

- Climb (or lift) for **the single best rooftop panorama in Prague** — red roofs, spires, the castle across the river.
- This view is why you can safely **skip all the parks/hills** (Petřín, Letná) later. Buy at the entrance desk inside the Old Town Hall — no pre-booking.

10:15 · 🚫 Tram 22 up to the castle — ~40 CZK

- **Tram 22** is *the* castle tram — it climbs the hill so you don't have to. Catch it toward **Pražský hrad** stop.
- Ticket: yellow machine at the stop or the PID Lítačka app; **validate on board** (stamp it) or you'll be fined. A 30-min ticket covers this ride.

10:45 · 🚫 Prague Castle + St. Vitus Cathedral + Golden Lane — ~450 CZK, walk-in (or hrad.cz)

- The **largest ancient castle complex in the world** — seat of Bohemian kings, Holy Roman emperors, and today the Czech president.
- **St. Vitus Cathedral** (begun 1344): soaring Gothic, crown jewels, royal tombs.
- ⭐ **Don't miss:** the **Mucha stained-glass window** · the **noon guard change** (you'll be right there) · **Golden Lane** — tiny 16th-c. houses where **Kafka lived at No. 22**.
- Go now (morning): fewer crowds, and **St. Vitus closes ~16:00**. Buy the circuit ticket at the on-site Info Centres (2nd/3rd courtyards) — walk-in.

12:15 · 💎 Nový Svět (+ Strahov Library if quick) — Free

- **Nový Svět** ("New World"): a tourist-free cobbled **fairytale lane** just behind the castle — postcard Prague without the crowds.
- If time/energy allows, **Strahov Monastery Library** nearby has a jaw-dropping baroque hall. Best photos of the morning.

13:00 · 🚫 VEG LUNCH — ~350 CZK

- 🌱 **Lehká Hlava ("Clear Head")** or **Maitrea** — both **100% vegetarian**, beautiful central interiors, ideal for a solo pure-veg traveler (same owners, both near Old Town).
- **Dishes:** at Lehká Hlava try the veg burger, quesadillas, or the daily veg risotto/curry; at Maitrea go for the "false meat" satay, veg noodles, or the tasting plates. Fresh juices at both.
- Back down: Tram 22 toward the river, or walk down through Malá Strana (~15 min, downhill) toward Charles Bridge.

14:15 •  **Charles Bridge (daytime) + Lennon Wall + Kampa Island — Free**

- **Charles Bridge** — commissioned by **Charles IV in 1357**, Gothic stone over the Vltava, lined with **30 baroque statues**, linking Old Town to Lesser Town. By day: buskers, artists, portrait painters.
- Right beside it: the **Lennon Wall** (ever-changing peace graffiti) and **Kampa Island** (leafy riverside). You'll cross the bridge again at night — a totally different experience.

15:00 •  **Jewish Quarter (Josefov) — walk free / ~500 CZK ticket**

- Europe's best-preserved former Jewish ghetto: the **Old-New Synagogue** (Europe's oldest active) and the haunting **Old Jewish Cemetery**.
- A combined ticket (~500 CZK) covers synagogues + cemetery; or just **walk the streets free** if you're low on energy.

16:00 •  **Speculum Alchemiae — ~200 CZK, walk-in**

- A **hidden medieval alchemy lab** with underground passages, near the Jewish Quarter — atmospheric guided peek into Emperor Rudolf II's alchemist Prague. Totally off the tourist track.

16:45 •  **Wander Old Town / Lesser Town — Free**

- Catch  **Hanging Freud** (David Černý's dangling man over **Husova St** — right on your route) and  **Klementinum** (stunning baroque library + astronomical tower, by Charles Bridge). Relax, coffee, soak in the streets.

17:45 •  **U Krále Brabantského — drinks ~€6–10 / CZK equivalent**

- **Prague's oldest tavern (~1375)** — mead, candlelight, medieval vibe. Go **for the atmosphere and a drink** (kitchen isn't veg-friendly — save your appetite for dinner).

18:30 •  **VEG DINNER — Dhaba Beas — ~400 CZK**

-  **Dhaba Beas** — Indian **vegetarian buffet** (pay by weight): dal, paneer sabzi, chana, rice, fresh rotis, salads — reliable comfort food after a long day.
- Backups if closed/full: **Country Life, Loving Hut** (both veg/vegan).

20:00 •    **Charles Bridge at NIGHT — Free**

- The bridge **empties out and lights up** — statues glow, the castle floodlit across the river. Completely different from the daytime crowd. **Best photos of the entire day**. Sunset is 20:13, so you catch blue hour → full dark right here.

21:15 •  **Nightcap (your call) — your budget**

- **U Sudu** — labyrinth underground wine bar (chill, atmospheric, solo-friendly).
- **Cross Club** — steampunk multi-level club (Holešovice).
- **Karlovy Lázně** — 5-floor mega-club by the bridge.
- Other gems: **Anonymous Bar** (V-for-Vendetta speakeasy) · **Vzorkovna "Dog Bar"** (grungy maze) · **Black Angel's** (1930s speakeasy).

Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Filmed Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Prague is one of the most-filmed cities on earth — and your route today walks straight through the famous scenes.

-  **Rockstar (2011, Ranbir Kapoor + Nargis Fakhri)** ★ — the **entire second half is set in Prague**. The songs "*Tum Ho*," "*Aur Ho*," "*Naadaan Parindey*" roam the exact spots on your route:
- **Charles Bridge** (both your day crossing at 14:15 and the night crossing at 20:00) — Jordan's most emotional moments.
- **Old Town Square + Astronomical Clock** (your 9:00 stop) — the street-life and busking scenes.
- **Prague Castle + the Vltava riverfront** (your 10:45 stop) — sweeping skyline shots.
-  **Linkin Park — "Numb" (2003)** ★ — the iconic outsider-student music video was shot right here: **Charles Bridge**, the **Old Town streets**, and a **Prague church** interior. When you walk the bridge and the Old Town lanes you're literally on the "Numb" locations.
-  **Mission: Impossible (1996)** — the original Tom Cruise film opens in Prague; the **Charles Bridge** and Old Town are key. You cross that same bridge twice today.
-  **Amadeus (1984)** — the Best-Picture Mozart epic was filmed across Prague's baroque core (it doubles for 18th-c. Vienna) — the streets around Old Town Square and the Lesser Town you wander this afternoon.
-  **Casino Royale** — Bond's Prague scenes (the film opens "in Prague"); the city's grand interiors stand in.
-  **Spider-Man: Far From Home** — Prague doubles as "Venice/Europe"; the Old Town Square and riverfront you visit appear as the film's European festival backdrop.
-  **The Bourne Identity & xXx** — both used Prague's bridges and Old Town streets for their chase/thriller sequences.

 **Do-it-yourself scene stops:** stand mid-**Charles Bridge** at night (Rockstar + Numb + M:I!), and again at the **Astronomical Clock** (Rockstar) — those two spots alone tick off most of the list.

💎 Offbeat bonus — David Černý sculpture hunt

- **Hanging Freud** — Husova St (on route) · **Kafka "Piss" sculpture** — by the Kafka Museum, Malá Strana (near the bridge) · **Rotating Kafka Head** — Quadrio, near Národní třída · **Upside-down horse** — Lucerna arcade (off Wenceslas Sq) · **Crawling babies** — Žižkov TV Tower.

⚠️ Nightlife safety — red-light scam warning

- Prague has **no Amsterdam-style window district**. Its adult venues (strip / "gentlemen's" clubs) cluster around **Wenceslas Square / New Town** side streets (**Ve Smečkách, Perlová**) and the main station.
- These are **notorious for scams**: €500+ inflated bills, credit-card fraud, aggressive touts.
- **If you go**: never follow a tout, agree prices upfront, **cash only (never card)**, set a limit, leave if it feels off. Honestly — safer and more fun to stick to Charles Bridge at night, U Sudu, Cross Club, or Karlovy Lázně.

📝 Practical tips (Prague)

- 💰 **Cash = CZK, not euro**. Town bank ATM only; avoid airport exchange & Euronet.
- 🚊 **Tram 22** = the castle tram. Buy at machine / PID Lítačka app, **validate on board**, ~40 CZK.
- 🚗 **Bolt** for airport↔hostel (~450 CZK) and any tired-leg hops.
- 👟 **Comfy shoes** — day is ~6–7 km, mostly flat (the tram handles the castle hill).
- ☔ **Umbrella + light morning layer** — 60% light showers, cool 16°C at 7 AM landing.
- 📖 **Message Prague Dream Hostel** to confirm early bag-drop (land 7 AM, check-in 3 PM).
- 🗺️ Nothing to pre-book — castle & towers are all **walk-in / on-site**.
- 🌐 **Skip**: all parks/hills (Letná, Petřín, Kampa hill, Vyšehrad) — the tower + castle already give you the skyline.
- 🌱 **Veg anchors**: Lehká Hlava / Maitrea (100% veg lunch), Dhaba Beas (Indian veg dinner), trdelník = veg. Backups: Country Life, Loving Hut.

🌙 Next morning

- **Aug 20 · 08:30** wake → Bolt to PRG → **11:00 flight to Barcelona** (join WanderOn). Intra-Schengen (no passport control). Pack tonight. Full plan → **Day-02**.